NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL → DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL → TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN → INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP → ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE → CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL MOSAIC

FOOD PRODUCTION | A REGIONAL MOSAIC | MIXED FARMING | SURPLUS/STORAGE WILD USE SELECTIVE TENDING HERITABLE CHANGE CROPS+HERDS DELAYED | NO UNIVERSAL PACKAGE | POLISHED STONE, POTTERY, HERDING AND CROPS APPEAR IN VARIED | NEOLITHIC CHANGES LIFEWAYS; CHALCOLITHIC ADDS COPPER WITHIN STONE-USING ECONOMIES.

FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable → No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order. → Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable change crops+herds delayed consumption
- No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.
- FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable change crops+herds delayed consumption

IMPACT / LIMIT

- No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.
- Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

01

STAGE 01

DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE

DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE | SEED-SIZE/RACHIS CHANGE + WEED ECOLOGY + STORAGE + GRINDING | MORPHOLOGY + AGE/SEX KILL PROFILE + CORRALS/DUNG + HERD | RISK BUFFERING | SOCIAL COMPETITION | NICHE CONSTRUCTION | DOMESTICATION NEEDS CONVERGING BIOLOGICAL AND CONTEXTUAL EVIDENCE. | RICE PRESENCE ALONE DOES NOT PROVE CULTIVATION; SECURE DATE

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- PLANTS: seed-size/rachis change + weed ecology + storage + grinding tools
- ANIMALS: morphology + age/sex kill profile + corrals/dung + herd demography
- CAUSES: climate

METHOD / DEBATE

- risk buffering
- social competition
- niche construction

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.
- Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

02

STAGE 02

TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN | POLISHED STONE + MICROLITHS + BONE TOOLS + POTTERY | LONGER RESIDENCE | ACCUMULATED PROPERTY CRAFT/EXCHANGE GROWTH DISEASE, LABOUR LOAD AND DIETARY

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and → dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses →
- storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.
- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses →

DEBATE / LEGACY

- storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and
- dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

03

STAGE 03

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP | LONG FARMING/HERDING SEQUENCE BEFORE HARAPPAN URBANISM | BURZAHOM, GUFKRAL | PIT DWELLINGS, BONE TOOLS, AGRO-PASTORALISM | VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA | KOLDIHWA, MAHAGARA, LAHURADEWA | RICE/DATE CAUTIONS | SHOULDERED CELTS AND REGIONAL LINKS; CHRONOLOGY REMAINS UNEVEN

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism → VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions → NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism
- KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions
- NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SOUTH: Utnur, Piklihal, Tekkalakota, Hallur → cattle, millets, ash mounds
- RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

04

STAGE 04

ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

ASH MOUNDS | FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE | BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT | SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND PERIODIC PEN BURNING COMMUNAL FEASTING | REPEATED FIRING AND CATTLE CENTRALITY ARE STRONG; ONE EXCLUSIVE USE UTNUR AND RELATED SITES AS A PASTORAL-LANDSCAPE PROBLEM

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice
- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.

METHOD / DEBATE

- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.
- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice

HISTORICAL RESULT

- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.
- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

05

STAGE 05

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES | REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX | CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS | GANESHWAR-JODHPURA COPPER CRAFT; HARAPPAN CONTACT | AHAR-BANAS AHAR, BALATHAL, GILUND BLACK-RED WARE; COPPER; FARMING | KAYATHA KAYATHA EARLY MALWA SEQUENCE; RICH DEPOSITS | MALWA NAVDATOLI, ERAN, NAGDA PAINTED WARE; LARGE VILLAGES; SPREAD | JORWE INAMGAON, NEVASA DECCAN HIERARCHY; LATE JORWE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS	Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits	OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact	Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread	
Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming	Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe	

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
- Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact
- Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
- Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread
- Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

DEBATE / LEGACY

- OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

06

STAGE 06

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY | VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS | CROP/HERD PRODUCTION | CRAFT WORK | EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS | SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND DIFFERENTIAL BURIALS MAY INDICATE INEQUALITY. | MOST SYSTEMS WERE REGIONAL AND RURAL, NOT FAILED HARAPPAN

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk → Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality. → Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks
- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.
- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.
- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

07

STAGE 07

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS | LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE | ARIDITY + PRODUCTION STRESS + SETTLEMENT REORGANISATION SOME ABANDONMENT | CAUTION 1 | ARCHAEOLOGICAL CULTURE | MATERIAL PATTERN, NOT A NAMED PEOPLE | CAUTION 2 | COPPER USE DOES NOT DISPLACE STONE OR PROVE URBANISATION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some
- abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies + local continuity

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.
- CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.
- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

08

STAGE 08

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE | 10 MARKS | DEFINE PHASE | TWO REGIONAL SITES | EVIDENCE CAUTION | 15 MARKS | TRANSITION CAUSES | DOMESTICATION PROOF

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution
- 15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society
- ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.
- CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

09

STAGE 09

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL | EVIDENCE LADDER | 1. TEST CULTIVATION, DOMESTICATION, SEDENTISM, POTTERY AND STORAGE SEPARATELY. | 2. ANCHOR EVERY CULTURE IN REGION, SITE, ASSEMBLAGE AND | 3. TREAT ADOPTION, LOCAL DEVELOPMENT, MOBILITY AND INTERACTION AS | NEOLITHISATION IS A REGIONAL MOSAIC, NOT ONE REVOLUTION OR

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Anchor every culture in region, site, assemblage and dated sequence.	VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.
1. Test cultivation, domestication, sedentism, pottery and storage separately.	3. Treat adoption, local development, mobility and interaction as testable models.	EVIDENCE LADDER

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. Test cultivation, domestication, sedentism, pottery and storage separately.

METHOD / DEBATE

- 2. Anchor every culture in region, site, assemblage and dated sequence.
- 3. Treat adoption, local development, mobility and interaction as testable models.

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

10

STAGE 10

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES | CLOSE DISTINCTIONS | 1. RICE PRESENCE IS NOT DOMESTICATION; A POLISHED CELT | 2. CHALCOLITHIC MEANS COPPER PLUS STONE, NOT UNIVERSAL METAL | 3. OCP, COPPER HOARDS AND GANESHWAR OVERLAP PARTLY BUT | CULTURE LABELS CLASSIFY ASSEMBLAGES; THEY DO NOT PROVE ETHNICITY

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CLOSE DISTINCTIONS	2. Chalcolithic means copper plus stone, not universal metal use or urbanism.	VERDICT: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.
1. Rice presence is not domestication; a polished celt alone is not farming.	3. OCP, copper hoards and Ganeshwar overlap partly but are not one people.	CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
- 1. Rice presence is not domestication; a polished celt alone is not farming.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Chalcolithic means copper plus stone, not universal metal use or urbanism.
- 3. OCP, copper hoards and Ganeshwar overlap partly but are not one people.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.
- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.

11

STAGE 11

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION | ANSWER SPINE | 1. USE 2021 Q37 TO SEPARATE BURZAHOM PITS, CHANDRAKETUGARH | 2. COMPARE NORTH-WEST, KASHMIR, GANGA/EAST, NORTH-EAST AND SOUTHERN PATHWAYS. | 3. WRITE CLAIM | CHRONOLOGY LIMIT. | RURAL FOOD-PRODUCING CULTURES OVERLAPPED, INTERACTED AND CHANGED UNEVENLY.

ANSWER SPINE → 1. Use 2021 Q37 to separate Burzahom pits, Chandraketugarh art and Ganeshwar copper. → 2. Compare north-west, Kashmir, Ganga/east, north-east and southern pathways. → 3. Write claim → site/culture → evidence → inference → chronology limit. → VERDICT: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ANSWER SPINE
- 1. Use 2021 Q37 to separate Burzahom pits, Chandraketugarh art and Ganeshwar copper.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Compare north-west, Kashmir, Ganga/east, north-east and southern pathways.
- 3. Write claim → site/culture → evidence → inference → chronology limit.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.
- ANSWER SPINE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA | 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION | 3. STUDY LINKS | 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) | 5. UPSC TRAPS | 6. CURRENT LINK | 7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Optional Advanced Case Clinics: Evidence Without Overreach — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- At Koldihwa, Mahagara, Pachoh and Indari, key issues are dates and whether rice remains are wild or domesticated.
- Upinder Singh also highlights Lahuradewa as evidence that the middle Ganga valley
- was an early rice-cultivation zone, preventing a single north-west-to-east diffusion model.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels